Creative assignment Writing 2

This assignment consists of two written products with supporting footnotes that belong together.

1. **Additional Chapter or Anecdote**

Students read a book from the booklist and write an additional chapter in which they try to convincingly imitate the writing style of the author. Alternatively, a student can draw inspiration from a personal anecdote to write an original piece in the style of the author.

2. **Argumentative Essay**

Students write an argumentative essay that argues that and how they have imitated the author in style. Students do this by comparing examples from the original to their own piece.

3. **Grammar footnotes**

Finally, students include grammar footnotes to show their competence in advanced grammar.

(1) The additional chapter or original anecdote

Based only on your reading of a book from the list below (see p. 5), select a theme or topic that reoccurs in the book. You reapply this theme/topic to a similar situation or event that the author could conceivably discuss or experience. You may write an additional chapter the the book or write a creative piece inspired by a personal anecdote with separate characters.

The books by Bill Bryson and Sarah Vowell concern travel writing. In that case you can select a destination or journey that fits logically in the book and that the author could conceivably discuss or experience. Travel writing is not the same as writing fiction or a straightforward narration of events. It exposes an underlying meaning of the journey by relating it to a theme, view of place, the life philosophy of the author, a series of personal insights, or the thoughts inspired by a place or travelling in itself. Instead of always being a "story", it can completely avoid chronology by allowing the place, the voice or even the interconnected impressions and memories of the writer to take centre stage.

(2) The argumentative essay

In your argumentative comparative essay, you show how you have copied 3 chosen style elements from the book.

- For the specific criteria set for this assignment, see p. 3
- For the required footnotes, see p. 4
- For the booklist, see p. 5

Deadlines

For <u>part-time students</u>, the hand-in for the Writing 2 assignment is open all year!
This means you can hand in your work in Gradework whenever suits you. We recommend handing in the assignment at the end of the Period that you take the course, but if you need more time, that is possible as well.

For <u>full-time students</u>, the hand-in for the Writing 2 assignment is set to Sunday in the test week for Period B.
However, the <u>RESIT</u> deadline for full-time students *is* open all year!

If you're handing in work outside of the periods in which the course is taught, you may hand in your work with any examiner. Do note that the assignments will be redistributed among the teachers who’re assigned to the course for that year.

All assignments that have been handed in before midnight on the Friday of each Test week will be marked by teachers in the three weeks following each test week.

- Full-time students take the course in Period B
- Part-time students take the course in Period C.

Assignment criteria Creative assignment Writing 2

- Expected length: aim for 900 words for the creative piece and 800 words for the argumentative essay. There is no hard limit for minimum or maximum number of words. Write enough to show your language level, and not too much to protect yourself and your teacher from too much work.

- One book from the book list below is used for this assignment.

  - Aim to reuse the new words discovered while reading, especially if they help recreate the sensibility or style of the author.

- Indicate your use of grammar elements a-r throughout your creative piece and essay by inserting footnotes

- In your argumentative essay, argue that the imitation of the chosen style is done effectively. The essay should therefore contain **3 body paragraphs**: for each body paragraph you argue how the creative piece effectively imitates an element of style. Provide analyses of examples from the original work as well as your imitation to prove your point. You can use the TEXAXAS-structure to help you effectively organise your paragraphs.

- The structure of your essay should adhere to the criteria for argumentative essays:
  - Introduction including thesis and arguments
    - Body paragraph 1: argument on style element 1
    - Body paragraph 2: argument on style element 2
    - Body paragraph 3: argument on style element 3
  - Conclusion including restated thesis and a summary of the arguments

- See “Assessment form Creative assignment Writing 2” for further specifics!

Required Grammar Footnotes in the creative assignment

Using the grammar reader and the knowledge acquired doing exercises in class, add footnotes to your creative assignment that identify the following items, adding the letter as well. These footnotes can be added both in the creative piece and the argumentative essay.

A. subordinate clause
B. coordinating conjunction
C. subordinating conjunction
D. simple sentence
E. complex sentence
F. relative pronoun
G. restrictive relative clause – explain what it modifies and why it is essential
H. non-restrictive relative clause – explain what it modifies and why it is not essential
J. conditional clause
K. adverbial clause
L. gerund
M. passive participle – name the actor that carries out the action named in the verb
N. active participle
O. past participle
P. indirect speech
Q. phrasal verb
R. prepositional idiom

Book List for the Creative assignment

Choose one book from the following list to read and use for the creative assignment. Excerpts of the books are discussed in class in week 1, and can be found on the Canvas page of module 1.

Bombeck, Erma:	Best-loved Writing from America's Favorite Humorist. 1997. 273 pages.
Bryson, Bill.	Lost Continent: Travels in Small Town America. 1990. 320 pages.
Clarkson, Jeremy.	Know You Got Soul. 2006. 288 pages.
Fey, Tina.	Bossypants. 2011. 288 pages.
Jobrani, Maz.	I'm not a Terrorist but I've Played One on TV: Memoirs of an Middle Eastern Funny Man. 2015. 240 pages.
Kaling, Mindy	Is Everybody Hanging out without Me? 2013. 240 pages.
May, James.	How to Land an A330 Airbus. 2011. 256 pages.
Mitchell, David.	Thinking about It only makes it Worse and other Lessons from Modern Life. 2015. 337 pages.
Moran, Caitlin.	How to be a Woman. 2011. 320 pages.
Noah, Trevor.	Born a Crime. Stories from a South African childhood. 2017. 304 pages.
Norton, Graham.	The Life and Loves of a He Devil. 2015. 304 pages.
Poehler, Amy.	Yes Please. 2014. 288 pages.
Vowell, Sarah.	Assassination Vacation. 2006. 272 pages
Williams, Wendy.	Ask Wendy: Straight-Up Advice about all the Drama in your Life. 2014. 336 pages.